

## READING PASSAGE 2

### The Impact of Digital Media on Journalism

**A** The study of the impact of digital media on journalism has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

**B** The origins of contemporary research in this area can be traced to pioneering studies conducted during the mid-twentieth century. These early investigations, though constrained by the technological and methodological limitations of their era, established foundational principles that continue to inform current scholarship. Successive generations of researchers have built upon these foundations, progressively refining theoretical models and expanding the empirical evidence base through increasingly sophisticated research designs.

**C** At the core of current understanding lies a set of interrelated mechanisms that collectively explain the observed patterns and outcomes. First, structural factors create the underlying conditions within which individual and collective action takes place. These structural dimensions include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and cultural norms that shape behaviour in ways that are often not immediately apparent to the actors themselves. Second, dynamic feedback processes amplify or dampen initial effects, generating patterns of change that can diverge substantially from what linear models would predict.

**D** The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

**E** The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

**F** Looking ahead, the field stands at a critical juncture. Emerging technologies offer unprecedented opportunities for data collection and analysis, potentially enabling researchers to address questions that have long remained beyond the reach of empirical investigation. At the same time, the accelerating pace of social and technological change means that the phenomena under study are themselves evolving, requiring theoretical frameworks that can accommodate dynamism and discontinuity rather than assuming stability and equilibrium.

**G** The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

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#### Question 1

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 1 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

**Question 2**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

**Question 3**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 3 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration

**Question 4**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

**Question 5**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 5 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
  - B. individual personality traits
  - C. random chance
  - D. government policies alone

**Question 6**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 6 Researchers used data from more than \_\_\_\_\_ countries in the landmark study.

### Question 7

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 7 Policy-makers have fully implemented all research recommendations.

### Questions 8–9

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. minimal impact
  - B. creating underlying conditions for action
  - C. determining individual choices directly
  - D. irrelevant to outcomes
- 9 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:
- A. inconsistent results across cultures
  - B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
  - C. no measurable effects
  - D. effects limited to Western countries

### Question 10

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 10 The author notes that researchers have called for more \_\_\_\_\_ approaches to investigation.

### Question 11

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

### Question 12

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 12 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of \_\_\_\_\_ years.

### Question 13

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

**13** The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:

- A. too much data collection
- B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
- C. insufficient government funding
- D. overly complex statistical methods